

SENATE No. 3247

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

**In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)**

Resolutions to call on the congressional delegation to support the treaty on the prohibition of nuclear weapons.

1 WHEREAS, the existence of more than 12,000 nuclear weapons worldwide poses a grave
2 and existential threat to the citizens of the commonwealth; and

3 WHEREAS, the residents of the commonwealth have expressed their deep concern about
4 this continuing threat over many decades through town meetings and city council resolutions and
5 the filing of bills and resolutions with the general court; and

6 WHEREAS, the policies and actions of states may lead the way and inspire important
7 changes nationally and internationally; and

8 WHEREAS, the commonwealth played a leading role in ending the nuclear arms race
9 with the Soviet Union in the 1980s, by adopting a nuclear freeze resolution and encouraging
10 other states to follow its example; and

11 WHEREAS, the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons, which entered into force
12 as international law on January 22, 2021, has been signed and ratified by 70 countries; and

13 WHEREAS, the legislatures of California, Oregon and Rhode Island, the Maine state
14 senate and the New Jersey assembly, and 21 cities and towns in the commonwealth have taken
15 action to denounce the threat of nuclear war by endorsing the national Back from the Brink
16 platform, which calls on our federal leaders to embrace the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear
17 Weapons and to take immediate steps to prevent nuclear war by actively pursuing a verifiable
18 agreement among nuclear-armed states to eliminate their nuclear arsenals, renouncing the option
19 of using nuclear weapons first, ending the President of the United States' sole, unchecked
20 authority to launch a nuclear attack, taking United States nuclear weapons off hair-trigger alert
21 and canceling the plan to replace its arsenal with enhanced weapons, mindful of prioritizing
22 national security; now therefore be it

23 RESOLVED, that the general court urges all members of the Massachusetts
24 congressional delegation to co-sponsor House Resolution 317 and Senate Resolution 323, which
25 call for the United States to adopt the policy provisions of the Back from the Brink platform; and
26 be it further

27 RESOLVED, that copies of these resolutions be transmitted forthwith by the clerk of the
28 Senate to the President and Vice President of the United States, the Speaker and Minority Leader
29 of the United States House of Representatives, the Majority and Minority Leaders of the United
30 States Senate, and to each Senator and Representative from the commonwealth in the Congress
31 of the United States, and to the governor of the commonwealth.